

KEVIN KAHWAI

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OBJECTIVE

Aspiring Digital Data & Information professional with a foundation in AWS cloud services (IAM, S3, Lambda, API Gateway) and CI/CD practices. Skilled in containerization (Docker) and monitoring (CloudWatch), with a keen interest in leveraging data to improve decision-making and digital transformation. Eager to contribute to BQI Tech by supporting innovative solutions, enhancing system reliability, and learning from industry experts to strengthen impact across communities.

EDUCATION

Bachelors Degree: Engineering: Technical University of Kenya(2023)

Relevant Coursework: Software Engineering

META-Front-End Developer Certificate : Meta

[View Certificate](#)

Google UX/UI Design Professional Certificate

[View Certificate](#)

AWS Solutions Architect - Associate :ALX

[View Certificate](#)

AWS Cloud Practitioner Foundations :ALX

[View Certificate](#)

Developing Cloud Apps with NodeJs and React : IBM

[View Certificate](#)

Linux Essentials : CISCO

[View Certificate](#)

Computer Networking : CISCO

[View Certificate](#)

SKILLS

- **Programming Languages** : Javascript(Proficient), Typescript(Prior Experience)
- **UI/UX & Design**: Figma, Responsive Design, Draw.io
- **Databases**: MongoDB, DynamoDB, Amazon RDS
- **Platforms** : Github, VS Code, Postman,Docker
- **Libraries**: ReactJS, NodeJS, ExpressJS
- **Cloud Technologies**: AWS, Azure and Oracle cloud.

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Software Developer

Jan 2023 - August 2023

Nairobi, Nairobi County

Key Responsibilities

- Developed and designed responsive web applications using HTML,CSS & JS ensuring optimal performance and user experience.
- Optimized front-end performance through code-splitting, lazy loading, and caching techniques.
- Data documentation, technical research and report writing
- Developed a strong understanding of user research, wireframing, and prototyping to create seamless digital experiences.
- Applied version control using Git and GitHub for collaborative development.
- Created reusable UI components and managed state efficiently using Redux and Context API to enhance maintainability.

EXPERIENCE

Cloud Architect

AWS Cloud Practitioner and AWS Solutions Architect

May 2024 - Present

Eldoret, Uasin Gishu County

Key Responsibilities

- **Deploy and manage cloud infrastructure** using AWS services such as EC2, S3, RDS, and Lambda to build efficient and resilient applications.
- **Architect secure and scalable cloud solutions** using AWS best practices, including high availability, fault tolerance, and cost optimization.
- **Configure networking solutions** using VPCs, subnets, route tables, and security groups to enhance security and network segmentation.
- **Monitor and optimize cloud environments** using AWS CloudWatch, AWS Trusted Advisor, and AWS Cost Explorer to track performance and reduce costs.
- **Work on serverless applications** by integrating AWS Lambda, API Gateway, and DynamoDB to create scalable and cost-effective solutions.
- **Implement disaster recovery and backup strategies** by implementing multi-region architectures, snapshots, and lifecycle policies.
- **Apply AWS Well-Architected Framework principles to automation** using services such as AWS CloudFormation and AWS CDK for infrastructure as code, AWS Config and CloudTrail for governance, AWS CloudWatch for monitoring, and AWS Lambda for serverless automation—ensuring secure, cost-optimized, and resilient deployments.
- **Extend serverless architectures using Amazon API Gateway** integrated with AWS Lambda, DynamoDB, and Amazon S3 to build scalable, event-driven applications while ensuring secure and reliable API management.
- **Implement AWS Well-Architected Framework principles to data pipelines** by leveraging AWS Glue for ETL, Amazon Kinesis for real-time data streaming, Amazon S3 for data lakes, and Amazon Redshift for analytics—ensuring scalability, security, and cost optimization.

PROJECTS

1. Splitting a monolith into containerized micro-services, and set up CI/CD pipelines for them using AWS Copilot.

- **Tools Used:** AWS Copilot, Amazon ECS, Amazon ECR, AWS CodePipeline, GitHub
- **What I Did:** Refactored a monolithic application into independent, containerized microservices and deployed them using AWS Copilot. Set up separate repositories for each service and implemented CI/CD pipelines through GitHub Actions and AWS CodePipeline.
- **Outcome:** Improved **deployment speed** and **scalability**, reduced **system downtime**, and simplified maintenance by enabling independent updates for each service.

2. Built a Serverless Web Application for Ride Requests

- **Tools Used:** AWS Cognito, AWS Lambda, Amazon API Gateway, Amazon DynamoDB, RESTful APIs
- **What I Did:** Designed and developed a serverless web app that allowed users to request rides from a virtual fleet. Implemented secure user authentication with AWS Cognito, backend logic with AWS Lambda, and exposed APIs via Amazon API Gateway. Used DynamoDB for scalable data storage and retrieval.
- **Outcome:** Delivered a **cost-effective, highly available, and scalable application** with faster response times, reduced infrastructure management overhead, and enhanced user experience through seamless authentication and request handling.

3. Orchestrated Queue-based Microservices with AWS Step Functions and Amazon SQS

- **Tools Used:** AWS Step Functions, Amazon SQS, AWS Lambda
- **What I Did:** Designed and implemented a serverless workflow that coordinated multiple microservices using AWS Step Functions. Integrated Amazon SQS for reliable message queuing and AWS Lambda for event-driven processing.
- **Outcome:** Improved **system reliability and fault tolerance** by decoupling services, enabled **scalable message handling**, and enhanced **operational efficiency** by automating workflow orchestration.

4. Configuring Hybrid Storage and migrating data with AWS Storage Gateway S3 File Gateway

- **Tools Used:** AWS Storage Gateway (S3 File Gateway), Amazon S3, AWS IAM
- **What I Did:** Connected on-premises file systems to Amazon S3 using AWS Storage Gateway (S3 File Gateway). Configured IAM policies for secure access, enabled caching for frequently accessed data, and performed seamless data migration from local systems to the cloud.
- **Outcome:** Achieved **cost-effective hybrid storage**, improved **data backup and disaster recovery capabilities**, and enabled **faster data access** through local caching while ensuring secure integration with AWS.

5. Designed and developed a responsive blog application

- **Tools Used:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript
- **What I Did:** Converted a static blog site into a fully functional web application by adding interactivity with JavaScript and enhancing design with modern responsive layouts.
- **Outcome:** Delivered a **mobile-friendly, cross-platform blog application** that improved user experience across all screen sizes and increased accessibility for end users.

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- I stay updated with industry trends by subscribing to engineering publications, participating in webinars, conferences, and actively engaging with professional networks and forums. Additionally, I make it a priority to seek out online courses and certifications to continually enhance my skills and knowledge, especially on safety in the utility industry
- I became a registered UrbanBetter Cityzen, joining an Africa-led global movement that leverages physical activity and precision advocacy to promote healthier and more sustainable urban environments. Through this initiative, I have gained access to specialized training and data collection tools, allowing me to contribute to research and urban health advocacy efforts. Additionally, I am on track to become a certified Run Leader, which will enable me to organize community runs and drive data-driven urban advocacy initiatives.
- I share technical snippets of what I learn through my social media post in linkedIn as well as document all my repositories in my GitHub profile

REFEREES

- PROF CLEOPHAS MAENDE

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